

TGB's Feedback, grievance redress and whistleblowing procedure

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1. Purpose and scope

- 1.1 This Policy establishes the framework for receiving, assessing, managing and resolving feedback and grievances arising from The Green Branch B.V. ("the Company")'s activities, projects, and business relationships.
- 1.2 This Policy applies to all employees, contractors, project partners, suppliers, and external stakeholders, including local communities affected by the Company's operations.
- 1.3 The Company is committed to ensuring that all stakeholders have access to a fair, transparent, and effective grievance mechanism, in line with internationally recognised human rights standards, including the [United Nations Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights \(UNGPs\)](#).

2. Guiding principles

- 2.1 The Company's grievance mechanism is designed and implemented in line with the effectiveness criteria set out under UNGP Principle 31, ensuring that it is:
 - Legitimate
 - Accessible
 - Predictable
 - Equitable
 - Transparent
 - Rights-compatible
 - A source of continuous learning
- 2.2 The mechanism is based on core principles of accessibility, fairness, transparency, and accountability, as recognised in international human rights

frameworks, including [guidance](#) from the Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights (OHCHR).

- 2.3 The Company is committed to ensuring that grievance mechanisms are culturally appropriate, inclusive, and adapted to local contexts.

3. Accessibility and project-level adaptation

- 3.1 The Company maintains a grievance mechanism accessible via its website and through direct communication channels.
- 3.2 The Company adapts grievance mechanisms at the project level to ensure accessibility for local stakeholders, including communities and workers, e.g., including different forms of communications for illiterate stakeholders, adapting languages and formats, such as printed grievance forms.
- 3.3 The standard grievance mechanism presented in this Policy is introduced and adjusted in a participatory manner during stakeholder consultations, conducted prior to project implementation in line with applicable [VCS](#) and [CCB](#) Standards.
- 3.4 When collaborating with other parties as Co-Proponents for a project, a different grievance mechanism might be used for project-related grievances, in accordance with involved parties and project stakeholders, and always in compliance with the guiding principles presented in section 2 of this Policy and with all applicable VCS and CCB Standards.
 - 3.4.1 The Company also recognizes that partners, contractors, suppliers, or other associated parties may maintain their own grievance mechanisms. Where such mechanisms exist, stakeholders may choose to use either the Company's mechanism or that of the relevant party, provided that such mechanisms are aligned with the guiding principles set out in section 2 of this Policy.
 - 3.4.2 The Company will, where feasible, assess the adequacy of such mechanisms as part of its due diligence processes.
 - 3.4.3 In case the mechanism described in section 4 of this Policy is not applied, for the above-mentioned reasons, project documents (i.e., Project Description Document, section 2.3.15) of each individual project can be used to verify what grievance mechanism is implemented.

- 3.5 The accessibility and effectiveness of the grievance mechanism are reviewed and, where necessary, revised at each project verification event or monitoring milestone.
- 3.6 The Company encourages partners, contractors, and suppliers to communicate available grievance channels to workers and stakeholders involved in project activities.

4. Grievance filing and redress procedure¹

4.1 Reception

- 4.1.1 The Company informs all stakeholders about the grievance forms and redress procedure through the stakeholder consultation or during in-person meetings, before project implementation (or new stakeholders' engagement in project activities) start.
 - 4.1.1.1 Stakeholders are also asked, during consultations, to propose alternative grievance mechanisms that might be more easily accessible and culturally appropriate to them.
- 4.1.2 The Company has designed grievance forms for stakeholders and employees that can be used to submit a grievance. These forms are accessible online on the Company's website (www.thegreenbranch.nl, File a grievance page).
 - 4.1.2.1 Depending on each project's stakeholder consultation's outcome, to ensure accessibility, printed versions of the grievance forms can also be made available on project sites.
 - 4.1.2.2 Grievance forms on the website are currently available in English and Portuguese but will be updated to be available in other languages, depending on the Company's project's location, to ensure linguistic accessibility.
 - 4.1.2.3 Grievance forms allow the filing party to indicate their name, contact details, and relationship to the Company (all optional), the date, type, reason for filing, and description of the event (mandatory), and suggestions on potential resolutions to the filed grievance (optional).

¹ As mentioned in section 3 of this Policy, this grievance redress procedure is the standard procedure used by the Company across its projects and operations, available to all stakeholders. Projects can have specific grievance mechanisms, co-designed with stakeholders, that may function differently than the one provided in section 4.

4.1.2.4 In the form, grievance can be classified in one of the following types:

- a. Environmental concerns:** any problem caused by damage to nature, such as pollution or harm to water sources.
- b. Social issues:** complaints about how the project affects your community, traditions, or ability to make a living.
- c. Health and Safety:** concerns about unsafe work conditions or risks to your health caused by the project.
- d. Labor and employment:** complaints about unfair treatment at work, like being underpaid, not being paid at all, or being treated unfairly.
- e. Sexual harassment or discrimination:** complaints regarding inappropriate behavior of a sexual nature in the workplace, such as unwanted advances, verbal or physical harassment, or discrimination based on gender or sexual orientation.
- f. Land and property rights:** problems about land use or ownership, such as planting trees on your property without your permission.
- g. Project management and implementation:** complaints about how the project is being managed, such as delays or promises not being kept by The Green Branch or another project partner.
- h. Financial transparency and ethical concerns:** concerns about how money for the project is being used, or potential cases of fraud, bribery, corruption or other unethical conduct.
- i. Breach of contract or agreement:** issues related to the violation of agreed terms and conditions in contracts between project partners or between the project proponent and other stakeholders.
- j. Other:** any other grievance that is not covered by the provided types.

4.1.3 Through the form, grievances can be filed anonymously or stating contact information.

4.1.3.1 For anonymous grievances, the Company will need to address the complaint without consulting the person who filed it, in the manner considered the most suitable by the Company.

4.1.4 Once submitted, grievances are directly processed by the Grievance Officer. The Grievance Officer is the Company's Head of Carbon Development, Miriam Bellink, assisted by the Carbon Development team, including ESG expertise. An email address linked to the grievance forms, where the grievances are automatically sent via the online forms, is also available.

4.2 Tracking

4.2.1 The Grievance Officer is responsible for maintaining a detailed record of grievance investigation and interaction with affected internal and external stakeholders.

4.2.1.1 All grievances and their redress procedure will be recorded in an internal Excel database accessible by the Grievance Officer. Grievances filed online are automatically recorded in the database, which is linked to the grievance forms.

4.2.1.2 The database will be made available to parties involved, when they are known, with the possibility to redact names and other personal information that could jeopardize confidentiality or anonymity, when required.

4.3 Screening

4.3.1 The grievance is screened by the Grievance Officer upon reception and, depending on the level of severity, categorized into one of the 3 stages of grievance redress:

a. Stage 1: Internal attempt of resolution

An answer to the grievance can be provided internally by the Grievance Officer without the need of external consultation. The Grievance Officer will give a written response to the person who filed the grievance, unless the grievance was filed anonymously.

b. Stage 2: Mediation by a neutral third party

A third-party mediation is necessary to solve the conflict. If needed, a legal advisor will be involved in the mediation process, collecting all necessary documentation from the Company and any involved party to present to the mediator and communicating on behalf of the Company the preferred solution for the grievance case. This stage will involve the person who filed the grievance, who will be contacted by the third-party advisor, unless the grievance was filed anonymously.

c. Stage 3: Arbitration or Court

In case the grievance is not resolved through mediation, the grievance case will be taken to court. Again, a legal counsel will represent the interests of the Project Proponent. This stage can only be carried out for grievances that are not filed anonymously.

4.3.2 Each grievance can either be assigned to any of the stages or, when deemed necessary, start at Stage 1 and proceed to subsequent stages in case of failure to resolve it at the previous stage.

4.3.3 At the screening stage, the Grievance Officer also verifies the type of the filed grievance (see 4.1.2.4) and validates or reassigns the classification.

4.4 Acknowledgement

4.4.1 Unless the grievance is anonymous, the Grievance Officer will contact the stakeholder who filed it within 30 business days after receiving the grievance by providing a formal acknowledgement, a summary of the case as well as an outline of the process, including an expected timeline.

4.4.1.1 Contact will preferably be established by email, depending on what contact information was provided by the filing stakeholder on the grievance form.

4.4.1.2 When email communication is not possible, the stakeholder will be reached out to via phone or any other contact information provided by the filing stakeholder on the grievance form.

4.5 Investigation and redress

4.5.1 The Grievance Officer is responsible for extensive investigation of the grievance, including consulting involved employees and/or external stakeholders, site visits and other potentially necessary actions to gain a holistic understanding of the case.

4.5.1.1 A detailed record of activities (with date, description, parties involved) is kept on the Excel grievance database and is considered essential to allow for in-depth analysis and subsequent planning of steps to resolve the case. These records can be made available to parties involved, if necessary, with the redaction of names and details that could jeopardize confidentiality or anonymity, when required.

4.5.2 The Grievance Officer is responsible for transparently communicating the developed plan to all affected parties, when possible, monitoring the actions taken, and meeting deadlines.

4.5.3 When all steps have been completed and a resolution has been reached that is satisfactory to both the grievance filing person/organization and The Green Branch, the case will be closed with written documentation of the resolution signed by both parties.

4.5.4 Possible outcomes of step 4.5 include successful resolution or appeal (following another round of step 4.5, or, in case of lack of resolution after appeal, escalation to a Stage 2 or 3 as per step 4.3).

4.5.4.1 Appeal can be requested in writing from the filing party during a period of 30 days after the resolution decision has been communicated to them by the Grievance Officer.

4.6 Follow-up, feedback, and data storage

4.6.1 The Grievance Officer will contact the parties involved (when known) 3-6 weeks after the case has been closed and ask for feedback on the process, which will be reflected upon internally by the Grievance Officer to improve future handling of grievance procedures.

4.6.2 All documentation of the grievance case will be stored for at least 3 years.

5. Confidentiality and non-retaliation

5.1 All grievances will be handled confidentially to the extent possible.

5.2 The Company prohibits any form of retaliation against individuals who raise concerns in good faith.

5.3 Information will be disclosed only where necessary for investigation and resolution, in accordance with applicable data protection requirements.

6. Whistleblowing and handling of sensitive grievances

6.1 The Company recognises that certain grievances may involve serious misconduct, including but not limited to corruption, fraud, legal violations, or breaches of company policies (type [h] grievances in section 4). Such cases are treated as whistleblowing reports and require enhanced confidentiality and handling.

6.2 Whistleblowing reports may be submitted through the same channels described in this Policy, including the Company's online grievance forms and designated email addresses.

6.3 Whistleblowing reports can be filed anonymously, through the grievance form.

- 6.4 The Grievance Officer also acts as Whistleblowing Officer and is responsible for identifying grievances that qualify as whistleblowing cases based on their nature and severity.
- 6.5 Where a grievance is classified as a whistleblowing case:
 - 6.5.1 It is immediately escalated to TGB Management (Directors) and to the Board of Advisors;
 - 6.5.2 It is handled with restricted access and enhanced confidentiality, with information shared strictly on a need-to-know basis;
 - 6.5.3 The Whistleblowing Officer may be excluded from handling the case where a conflict of interest exists, in which case responsibility is transferred to TGB Management or an appropriate independent party;
 - 6.5.4 Investigations may be conducted internally or, where appropriate, with the support of external advisors to ensure impartiality and objectivity.
- 6.6 All whistleblowing reports are subject to the same principles of non-retaliation, confidentiality, and fair treatment as set out in this Policy.

7. Roles and responsibilities

- 7.1 Designated grievance officers are responsible for managing the grievance process, maintaining records, and ensuring timely resolution. The Head of Carbon Development and ESG personnel at the Company are leading the process for grievance reception, tracking, and resolution.
 - 7.1.1 The main TGB Grievance Officer also acts as Whistleblowing Officer and ensures that sensitive grievances are identified, escalated and handled in accordance with section 6 of this Policy.
 - 7.1.2 Additional roles and responsibilities may be defined at project level, based on the specific project's grievance mechanism (e.g., community grievance officers might be appointed under compensation for cultural context that require in-person support to receive and address grievances).
- 7.2 Management is responsible for oversight of grievance handling and ensuring that adequate resources are allocated.
- 7.3 All employees and partners are responsible for reporting grievances and cooperating with investigations, when required.

8. Monitoring and continuous improvement

- 8.1 The Company reviews grievance data periodically to identify systemic issues and improve operational practices.
- 8.2 The number of grievances received for a specific project is monitored at every verification event, and company-level monitoring of the number and type of grievances received is implemented, to inform future policies and preventive and corrective measures.
- 8.3 Feedback collected during follow-up processes is used to enhance the effectiveness and accessibility of the grievance mechanism.
- 8.4 Lessons learned are integrated into the Company's *ESG Management System* and company policies during periodic reviews (including the revision of this Policy).